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KGiSL Campus, Saravanampatti, Coimbatore – 641 035

[Bsc.Computer Science]

Case Study Report

2025 – 2026

[Night Of The Scorpion]

KG College of Arts and Science
Saravanampatti
Coimbatore

Student Name	Gughan s
Register Number	25bcs114

Class	I Bsc Cs B
Course Name	English 2
Semester	II
Course Code	24ENG22L
Date of Submission	05/01/2026

1. Brief Overview of the Study (150-200 words)

Night of the Scorpion is a well-known poem by Indian poet Nissim Ezekiel that portrays a domestic incident in a rural Indian setting. The poem narrates the experience of a mother who is stung by a scorpion while working at night, and the reactions of villagers and family members who gather to help her. Through this simple incident, Ezekiel highlights deeper human emotions and social values.

The central focus of the poem is the theme of sacrifice, especially maternal sacrifice. The mother silently endures severe pain while others around her express fear, superstition, and concern. Despite suffering

intensely for hours, she never complains. At the end of the poem, she expresses gratitude that the scorpion chose to sting her instead of her children. This moment reveals the depth of a mother's selfless love and willingness to suffer for her family.
This case study examines how Ezekiel uses ordinary events, realistic imagery, and simple language to emphasize sacrifice as a powerful human virtue. The poem reflects Indian cultural values and highlights emotional strength over physical suffering.

2. Identification of the Problem (100-150 words)

The main issue explored in this case study is how sacrifice is expressed and understood through human behavior during crisis situations. In Night of the Scorpion, the mother faces intense physical pain caused by the scorpion sting, yet her emotional response reveals a deeper moral strength. While villagers attempt to help using prayers, rituals, and superstitions, the mother remains

quiet and patient.
The problem lies in understanding why the poet places so much importance on the mother's silent endurance rather than the dramatic reactions of others. The poem raises questions about human values, selflessness, and emotional resilience. This case study seeks to identify how sacrifice becomes meaningful through personal suffering and how it contrasts with fear, ignorance, and external reactions shown by others in the poem.

3. Objectives, Background and Scope of the Study (200-300 words)

Objectives:
To analyze the theme of sacrifice in Night of the Scorpion.
To understand maternal sacrifice as portrayed by Nissim Ezekiel.
To study how pain and selflessness are represented through poetic techniques.
Background:
Nissim Ezekiel is regarded as one of the

pioneers of modern Indian English poetry. His poems often depict everyday life, social realities, and human emotions with clarity and realism. Night of the Scorpion is based on a real-life incident from the poet's childhood. The poem reflects rural Indian beliefs, family bonds, and emotional values.

Scope of the Study:

This study focuses mainly on the emotional and moral aspects of sacrifice shown in the poem. It does not concentrate on literary devices alone, but rather on the human values expressed through the mother's character. The scope includes examining cultural attitudes, maternal instincts, and silent endurance. The study also highlights how sacrifice is portrayed as natural and unconditional, especially in the context of motherhood. Through this analysis, the poem is understood as a reflection of universal human values beyond time and place.

4. Detailed Description of the Study (300-400 words)

The poem begins with the scorpion stinging the poet's mother, setting the stage for a scene filled with fear, confusion, and concern. Villagers rush in with candles and lanterns, chanting prayers and offering traditional remedies. Their actions, though well-intentioned, are driven largely by superstition. Amidst this chaos, the mother remains the central figure of suffering.

The poet carefully contrasts the reactions of the villagers with the silent endurance of the mother. While others talk continuously and express their fears loudly, the mother tolerates pain without complaint. Her sacrifice is not forced or dramatic; instead, it is calm and natural. This highlights the strength of her character.

The climax of the poem comes at the end when the mother, after enduring pain for twenty hours, finally recovers and says she is thankful that the scorpion stung her and spared her children. This statement powerfully conveys the theme of sacrifice. Her gratitude shows unconditional love and selflessness, as she considers her children's

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safety more important than her own suffering.

Ezekiel's use of simple language and realistic imagery makes the sacrifice appear genuine and relatable. There is no exaggeration, yet the emotional impact is strong. The mother's sacrifice stands as a symbol of maternal love that transcends pain and fear. Through this portrayal, the poet suggests that true sacrifice lies in silent endurance and selfless concern for others.

5. Analysis through data/Charts/Tables

Aspect
Description
Situation
Mother bitten by scorpion
Response of Villagers
Superstition, prayers, rituals
Mother's Reaction
Silent endurance
Key Statement
Thankful children were safe
Theme Highlighted

Sacrifice and maternal love

6. Key insights drawn from the analysis (200-300 words)

The analysis of Night of the Scorpion reveals that sacrifice is portrayed as an instinctive and emotional act rather than a conscious decision. The mother does not express fear or anger; instead, she quietly bears the pain. This shows that sacrifice often involves acceptance and patience rather than resistance.

Another key insight is the contrast between true sacrifice and superficial concern. While villagers appear actively involved, their actions are based on superstition and fear. In contrast, the mother's sacrifice is genuine and deeply emotional. Her final statement reflects selfless love, which becomes the emotional core of the poem.

The poem also suggests that sacrifice is closely linked to motherhood. The mother's willingness to suffer for her children highlights the universal nature of maternal

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love. This sacrifice is not limited to physical pain but extends to emotional strength. Finally, Ezekiel emphasizes that sacrifice does not need recognition or praise. The mother does not seek sympathy; her strength is revealed only at the end. This reinforces the idea that real sacrifice is quiet, unconditional, and deeply human.

7. Conclusion(100-150 words)

In conclusion, Night of the Scorpion effectively presents the theme of sacrifice through the character of the mother. Nissim Ezekiel uses a simple incident to highlight profound human values. The mother's silent endurance and selfless gratitude reveal the true essence of sacrifice.
The poem contrasts fear and superstition with emotional strength and unconditional love. Through realistic portrayal and simple language, Ezekiel makes the theme universally relatable. This case study shows that sacrifice, especially maternal sacrifice, is a powerful force that defines human relationships.

The poem ultimately reminds readers that love and selflessness are stronger than pain and fear.

8. References (Minimum 5 References)

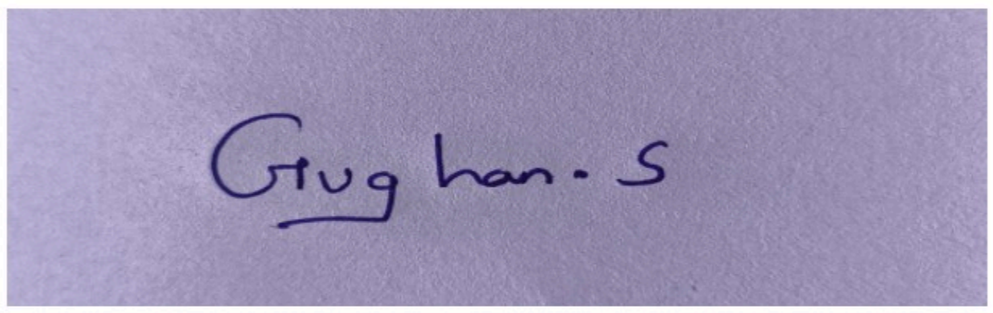
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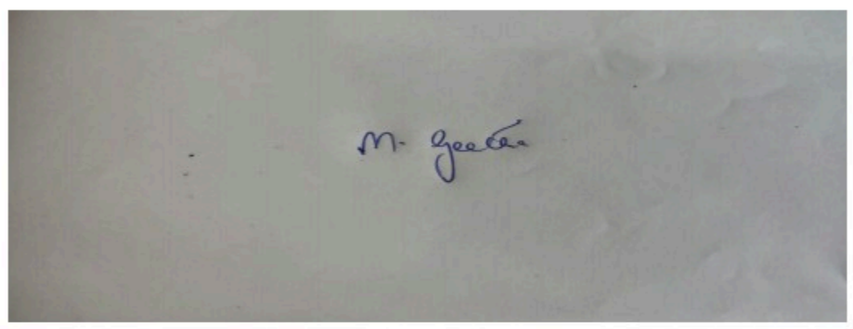
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[E-Sign]
Student



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Faculty incharge